



DIRECTORS NOTE

GHOSTBIRTH2

A film by Marius Jopen

www.ghostbirth2.com

contact@ghostbirth2.com

I didn't come up with Ghost Birth 2. It basically happened to me.

In 2023, my debut film Space Birth (a self financed science fiction film built with 300 volunteers and a spaceship made of cardboard) screened at Cinema Oasis in Bangkok. Cinema Oasis is an independent cinema and art space founded by Ing Kanjanavanit, the Thai director whose film Shakespeare Must Die was banned by the government as a national security threat, and Manit Sriwanichpoom, one of Thailand's most important contemporary artists and photographers. Space Birth won an award for most shocking film. Ing invited me to stay for a residency.

During that month, I went to a massage studio near Cinema Oasis almost every day. Professional place, good massages, mostly tourists and Japanese clients. After about thirty sessions, Ing asked me if I knew the history of the building. I didn't. She told me that thirty years ago, the house had burned down. A pregnant woman had died inside. Thai people believe that her ghost never left. The locals in the neighborhood avoid the place. That's why there are no Thai customers.

I had been already going there for a month. I was inside a ghost story already. That was the moment I knew this has to be my next film.

I went back to Bangkok twice after that. The second time, I spent a month in the studio trying to write a script. Also I tried to make contact with the ghost. Telepathically, through research, through whatever I could think of. It was amateurish. But something opened up. Thailand has a deep, living culture of spirits. Not the Hollywood kind, but something older and more present. Ghosts are part of daily life. People leave offerings. Buildings carry histories and small ghost-houses. I began to understand that the film I wanted to make could not exist anywhere else.

The third time, I brought money. Seven thousand euros of my own. I ran a casting with 140 people, tested

14 actors, flew in a cinematographer from Australia, rented massage studios, scouted locations. I learned what it means to shoot an independent film in Bangkok. The light, the humidity, the chaos, the daily problems nobody warns you about. I came home with test footage and a better understanding of how to make this film.

Ghost Birth 2 2 is a horror film about motherhood. Not the version you see on social media. Glowing, beautiful, fulfilled. The other version. The desperation of wanting a child and not being able to have one. The social pressure that tells women their lives are incomplete without motherhood. The willingness to accept anything, from anyone, at any cost, just to become a mother. And the reality that motherhood itself (when it comes) can be raw, chaotic, and nothing like what you were promised.

I know this subject from many sides.

I am adopted. My mother could not have children. She and my father traveled to Brazil to adopt me when I was six weeks old. I grew up in Germany, loved and cared for, But I have always known that I exist because someone wanted a child badly enough to travel all the way to Brazil.

A woman I was close to went through artificial insemination. She told me everything. The hormones, the procedures, the toll it takes on a body and a mind. A close friend of mine, an artist who works on the subject of motherhood in her practice, experienced severe depression after giving birth. She describes motherhood as something dirty, something insane. The opposite of what society tells women it should be. My best friend is a single mother. The father is absent. I am the child's godfather. I have seen, up close, how a child can drain every ounce of energy from a person who loves them.

And I am a man who has frozen his sperm and is considering a vasectomy. I am not ready for the responsibility.

The first version of Ghost Birth 2 reflected that. It was about a man who runs from fatherhood. The haunted house made his girlfriend pregnant from a distance while he hid in Bangkok. That man was me. The film has changed since then. It is no longer about a man who runs. It is about a woman who stays. Elena knows what is growing inside her. She knows the child belongs to a ghost. She knows the house is a machine. And she chooses to keep it. That choice is the center of the film.

Saul, the taxi driver who tries to rescue Elena, carries something of the old version of the story. He is the man who once ran away. Now he tries to save someone. Maybe out of guilt, maybe out of decency. But you cannot save someone who does not want to be saved.

Ghost Birth 2 is a slow burn. Not a slasher, not a jump-scare machine. A film that builds dread through atmosphere, through texture, through the feeling that something is deeply wrong with the space you are in. The building is the antagonist.

All effects will be practical. I come from the world of AI and creative technology. I could use digital tools. I choose not to. Ghost Birth 2 will be built by hand, on set, with cardboard, latex, light and sweat. The body horror in this film needs to feel physical. The audience needs to feel it.

Bangkok is the only city where this film can exist. Not because of exoticism. But because of what the city does to a European mind. Bangkok is anarchic, overwhelming, alive in a way that Berlin is not. Elena arrives from a world where infertility is a medical problem with clinical solutions. She lands in a world where a building can be a ghost, where spirits live inside walls, where the rules she knows don't apply. That tension, between European rationality and Bangkok's spiritual reality, is the engine of the film.

Space Birth 2 took three years, 300 volunteers, and all self-financed. A man flies through space, falls in love, and in the moment of union the woman transforms into an organism that harvests his body for reproduction. Ghost Birth 2 continues that obsession. Both films are about desire being used against the one who desires. The difference is: The astronaut dies. Elena says yes.

Ghost Birth 2 is my second film. I will shoot it in Bangkok in late 2026 with a small international and local crew, practical effects, and the support of Cinema Oasis Foundation. Ing Kanjanavanit and Manit Sriwanichpoom (a filmmaker who fought government censorship and an artist whose work has challenged Thai society for decades) have already offered their space, their network, and their knowledge of independent production in Thailand. I cannot imagine better allies for a film about a woman who refuses to let anyone tell her what she is allowed to want.

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+49 176 233 670 79

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